

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 29, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for Tuesday, September 29, 2026 - Part 2 - focus: continuing the Prah.dev Portfolio after the earlier September 29 workspace, workflow-tab, and landing-hero record, re-verifying the United States Eastern date, running the customary project reader, extracting and studying all forty-four pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, preserving the local Next.js preview, replacing the Core Beliefs outline star with the final multicolor raster treatment, scaling and centering the star across the five belief bubbles, extending My Workflow into a taller image-backed seven-stage presentation, adding responsive royalty-free reference imagery and transparent tab-gap cutouts, directing each belief-bubble opacity gradient toward the star center, removing the star PNG's visible black rectangle through corrected layer compositing, refreshing Featured Case Studies commit and worklog quantities from the four remote GitHub repositories, validating TypeScript and local routes, documenting committed source state d6af41d, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, and generating the September 29 Part 2 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_september29.pdf and its documentation commit 2e60627. The source state reviewed for this record is d6af41d7ca989395c01d52693ef4f2c75fb05112 on main, matching origin/main, titled Updated featured case study commit and worklog counts. The Part 2 work is represented by four source commits: 77dd0d6, 092f91d, 147b9e8, and d6af41d. Together they changed app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, the committed snapshot, five Core Beliefs star PNGs, and seven workflow JPEGs, with 223 insertions and 52 deletions across tracked text files relative to the first September 29 worklog commit. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, static production publish, GitHub Actions dispatch, or public deployment was performed during this record. The documentation deltas created by this generation pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this September 29 Part 2 root-level PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an external UTC-04:00 time check, which reported September 29, 2026 at 10:30 PM. September remains on Eastern Daylight Time, so this record uses Tuesday, September 29, 2026 rather than relying on a host or UTC calendar date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the established practice of capturing current source, assets, configuration, Git context, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Extracted and studied all forty-four pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, and fourteen September records through portfolio_worklog_september29.pdf. Before this artifact, the series contained 256 PDF pages and approximately 121,639 extracted words.
- Compared the complete record set for filename cadence, same-day Part suffix behavior, title construction, opening-summary density, source and baseline framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, dated footers, and output-artifact closure.
- Used the first September 29 record as the direct chronological baseline, September 15 for the original Core Beliefs formation and prior case-study counter refresh, September 21 for the workflow narrative, and the September 8 and September 12 Part 2 records for same-day continuation naming and scope separation.
- Checked pdftinfo and pdffonts against the mature series. The established artifact remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, no encryption, Codex metadata, dense black-on-white technical copy, and a repeated dated page footer.
- Reviewed commits 77dd0d6, 092f91d, 147b9e8, and d6af41d through git log, git show, git diff, commit bodies, file statistics, branch tracking, and the refreshed project snapshot. Confirmed main and origin/main resolve to the same final commit.
- Reviewed app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, app/PortfolioSections.tsx, the current landing route, all new public/images/aboutdev assets, and the refreshed snapshot as the source and documentation files carrying the Part 2 work.
- Queried the remote GitHub repositories through the authenticated GitHub API rather than relying on local clones. Used default-branch commit history totals and recursive remote tree inventories to verify both commit and PDF worklog counts.

Baseline Status Before September 29 Part 2 Work

- The first September 29 record had completed the mirrored My Work Space / My Work Tools system, expanded My Workflow into seven number/name tab stages, and refined the landing hero profile, devices, and quote. The workflow tabs still used their earlier 85px height, twenty-percent name width, and text-led presentation without image strips.
- My Core Beliefs still depended on the earlier outline-star treatment. The next visual direction required a richer multicolor image, equal interaction with all five bubbles, careful scaling and vertical centering, and a way to preserve the page grid despite the selected raster file's opaque black field.
- The seven workflow stages had the desired forward-and-return placement but lacked visual reference material. Banner/tab transitions, rail endpoints, responsive image crops, and the relationship between index tabs and name tabs still needed a full image-backed pass.
- Number and name tabs visually touched one another. The requested final treatment needed a deliberate horizontal separation that remained genuinely transparent, did not show image pixels, did not carry a top border across the opening, and did not leak through either rounded corner.
- Featured Case Studies still displayed the September 15 repository quantities: Cinerific at 66 commits and 20 worklogs, Alla Vostra at 384 and 65, Credit King at 82 and 0, and Prahlin.dev at 110 and 37.

Goals for September 29 Part 2

- Replace the Core Beliefs outline treatment with the accepted beliefs-star4.png artwork while preserving the five-circle formation, bubble copy, accent colors, and responsive hiding behavior.
- Scale and position the star so its five points meet the bubbles evenly, with only intentional user-directed size and vertical changes and no unrelated alteration to the surrounding section.
- Increase workflow banner and tab height, widen name tabs, preserve the established seven-stage stagger, and add one unique full-width thematic image per stage across wide, portrait, and narrow layouts.
- Keep the image subtly visible beneath the number and name tabs while establishing a truly transparent eight-pixel separation between them, including clean top-border and rounded-corner handling.
- Apply individually measured bubble-opacity gradients toward the star's shared center while leaving the star asset itself unchanged, then eliminate the selected PNG's black rectangular field without destructively editing the source file.
- Recalculate only the Featured Case Studies commit and worklog quantities from the four remote GitHub repositories and leave every other card property unchanged.
- Validate TypeScript, local routes, responsive geometry, repository state, and documentation conventions before generating the same-day Part 2 PDF.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Star Asset and Formation

- Explored several star treatments before settling on the user-supplied raster sequence. Imported beliefs-star.png, beliefs-star2.png, beliefs-star3.png, beliefs-star4.png, and beliefs-star-forest-border.png into public/images/aboutdev so the accepted state and prior iterations remain represented in repository history.
- Replaced the temporary generated-gradient treatment with the user's successive star files, reverted when requested, and finalized beliefs-star4.png as the rendered asset in app/page.tsx.
- Increased the star beyond its earlier size, then tuned the final formation through forty-percent and forty-five-percent passes. The accepted CSS uses a 60.668 percent formation width and a 45 percent vertical center so all five arms reach toward their related circles without changing bubble coordinates.
- Nudged the star upward in measured increments so the upper and lower intersections read evenly, then protected the chosen position through the later bubble-gradient and compositing work.
- Kept the star behind the belief circles with pointer events disabled. The narrowest portrait formation still hides the star and stacks the circular cards, preserving the established mobile fallback.
- Confirmed that the selected 2012 x 1956 RGBA PNG visually contains a black rectangular field despite having an alpha-capable file format. The source artwork itself was not regenerated or destructively color-keyed during the final fix.

Work Completed - Taller Seven-Stage Workflow Presentation

- Increased workflow tab height from 85px to 127.5px and banner minimum height from 118px to 177px, producing the requested fifty-percent vertical increase for both tab and banner zones.

- Set vertical stack spacing to half the tab height, or 63.75px, and extended the connecting rail through the inter-stack gaps while limiting its endpoints to the 02 through 06 region. The rail no longer reaches the 01 or 07 header zones.
- Matched number-tab fill, opacity, border color, and seam behavior to the name tabs. Both use the same 95 percent dark surface so imagery can register subtly without creating a second visual system.
- Widened all name-tab tracks from twenty percent to twenty-four percent while retaining ten-percent number tabs on wide layouts. Portrait layouts retain their twenty-percent index and forty-percent name proportions.
- Rebalanced the wide stagger to 0, 22, 44, and 66 percent tracks for the forward path and mirrored those positions back through stages 05, 06, and 07. In portrait and narrow modes, all seven number/name pairs align with stage 01.
- Removed unwanted top-left and top-right banner rounding where the raised image/tab zone transitions into the body. Preserved the lower banner rounding and corrected the corresponding stage 07 corner behavior.
- Added a targeted two-pixel Analyze name-tab width correction at wider aspect ratios so the image strip cannot bleed outside the stage 04 tab edge.

Work Completed - Responsive Workflow Image Strips

- Added one unique locally stored image for each workflow stage: workflow-research-strip.jpg, workflow-plan-strip.jpg, workflow-scaffold-strip.jpg, workflow-analyze-strip.jpg, workflow-testing-strip.jpg, workflow-building-strip.jpg, and workflow-release-strip.jpg.
- Used royalty-free web imagery relevant to research, planning, code scaffolding, analysis, testing, building, and release. Replaced the first Release choice with a softer smartphone-and-bokeh composition after visual review.
- Added a timelineHeaderImages data structure with descriptive alternative text and rendered each image through Next Image as a full-width strip behind its stage tabs.
- Standardized every strip to the 127.5px tab height, centered object-fit cropping, restrained brightness, contrast, and saturation, and a stage-specific vertical crop adjustment for the Release image.
- Extended the same full-width strip behavior into portrait and narrow layouts rather than hiding the imagery. Compressed layouts retain their established left-aligned tab pair and crop only the image's side content as available width decreases.
- Tuned the image visibility beneath tab surfaces through successive opacity reductions from fifty percent to five percent. The final 95 percent tab surface preserves legibility while allowing only a quiet reference to the image below.
- Corrected stage 04 image bleed, banner/image transition rounding, and both left and right strip edges across stages 02 through 07 so the image and banner geometry remain visually continuous.

Work Completed - Tab Separation and Transparent Image Cutouts

- Added an eight-pixel horizontal gap between every number tab and name tab across all seven stages and every responsive arrangement. Reduced name-tab width by the same amount so each pair preserves its original total footprint and outer alignment.
- Replaced the initially visible image-backed gap with an actual alpha cutout in the image layer. The cutout follows each stage's responsive pair position rather than assuming one fixed screen coordinate.
- Diagnosed a one-pixel discrepancy between the bordered image wrapper and the image content box. Shifted the cutout origin to the rendered image pixels so the transparent band begins at the exact number-tab edge and ends at the exact name-tab edge.
- Removed the short image-strip top border that appeared to connect the two rounded tabs. Rebuilt the strip border as two physically separate pseudo-element segments, leaving no border object above the gap.
- Expanded the image cutout ten pixels beneath both inner tab edges. This deliberate under-coverage prevents antialiased image fragments or top-border fractions from escaping beyond the rounded corners; clean corners take priority over filling every concealed pixel.
- Verified the final visible gap remains eight pixels in wide, portrait, and narrow browser measurements even though the hidden image cutout extends farther under the tabs for safety.

Work Completed - Center-Directed Bubble Opacity and Star Compositing

- Added a dedicated gradient angle variable to each belief bubble and aligned the five values to the shared star center: 180 degrees, 259.5 degrees, 328 degrees, 32 degrees, and 100.5 degrees.

- Applied the gradient only to bubble backgrounds. Text, accent-colored borders, halo rings, star dimensions, star placement, and image opacity remained independent.
- Began with a complete fade at the center-facing edge, then softened the effect after review so bubbles cover more of the star. The final stops transition through 92, 84, 60, and 26 percent opacity, retaining the directional read without making the circle interiors disappear.
- Tested screen blending on the image itself and confirmed the black rectangle remained because the principles grid established an isolated compositing context. Clearing the Next.js cache correctly proved the artifact was compositing behavior rather than stale CSS.
- Removed the grid isolation and moved screen blending to the complete star layer. This lets near-black raster pixels contribute no visible rectangle against the live page backdrop while preserving the multicolor glow, star outline, and underlying green grid.
- Kept beliefs-star4.png byte-for-byte unchanged during the final black-background correction. The solution is nondestructive CSS and can be reverted or replaced later if a genuine transparent source asset becomes available.

Work Completed - Remote Featured Case Study Counts

- Identified the four canonical remotes as Prahlin/cinerific, Prahlin/alla_vostra, Prahlin/creditking, and Prahlin/portfolio through the authenticated GitHub CLI account rather than inferring repository names from local directories.
- Queried each default branch through GitHub GraphQL commit history totals and enumerated each remote main-branch tree recursively for PDF paths containing worklog.
- Updated Cinerific from 66 to 101 commits and from 20 to 29 worklogs.
- Updated Alla Vostra from 384 to 393 commits and from 65 to 69 worklogs.
- Confirmed Credit King remains correct at 82 commits and 0 worklogs, so its source strings were not changed.
- Updated Prahlin.dev from 110 to 133 commits and from 37 to 44 worklogs.
- Changed only the stat and worklogStat strings in app/PortfolioSections.tsx. Card copy, links, tags, screenshots, order, global proof totals, and project-page counters remained outside this narrowly requested refresh.

Work Completed - Cache Handling and Documentation Context

- Cleared generated .next state and restarted the Next.js 16.2.10 Turbopack server when CSS changes appeared stale in the browser. Moved caches to recoverable temporary locations instead of deleting project source or assets.
- Kept the local preview available at http://127.0.0.1:3000 and used installed Google Chrome through Playwright to inspect image strips, tab gaps, transparent masks, rounded-corner coverage, bubble gradients, and star compositing.
- Recommended past-tense commit messages during the work sequence, then reviewed the resulting four committed records and their bodies for this consolidated Part 2 worklog.
- Ran the customary project reader again during worklog generation so the snapshot now records final source state d6af41d and the complete pre-Part-2 PDF inventory.

Committed Source Sequence

- Commit 77dd0d6, Refined Core Beliefs Star Presentation with a custom generated, multi-colored, stylish opacity gradient star from Figma, established the raster-star asset history and final beliefs-star4.png selection. It changed app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, the snapshot, and five new PNG assets.
- Commit 092f91d, Enhanced the My Workflow timeline with responsive imagery, delivered the dominant Part 2 layout pass. It added seven JPEG assets, the timeline image data and markup, taller tabs and banners, wider name tracks, responsive strips, rail refinements, transparent gaps, and bleed-free rounded-corner handling. The commit added 182 lines and removed 20 across application source.
- Commit 147b9e8, Refined the My Core Beliefs star composition, added the five center-directed bubble gradients, softened the final coverage, removed grid isolation, and moved screen blending to the star layer so the baked black rectangle no longer reads as a square.
- Commit d6af41d, Updated featured case study commit and worklog counts, changed only twelve quantity lines in app/PortfolioSections.tsx and closed the source sequence at the verified remote values.

- The four commits form one coherent landing-page proof pass: Core Beliefs received its final visual centerpiece, My Workflow gained photographic process evidence, bubble/star compositing became intentional, and Featured Case Studies metrics were reconciled against current repository truth.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed against final source state d6af41d with tsc --noEmit.
- Confirmed the local landing route and /aboutdev each returned HTTP 200 from the running Next.js 16.2.10 Turbopack server during the documentation pass.
- Browser verification covered 1440 x 900 wide, 760 x 900 portrait, and 600 x 500 narrow reference viewports. Every workflow pair measured an eight-pixel visible gap, and all seven stages retained the intended responsive pair alignment.
- Computed-style checks confirmed the image cutout follows the responsive pair variables, tab backgrounds remain at 95 percent opacity, the star layer uses screen blending, the star image itself uses normal blending, and the principles grid no longer isolates the compositing group.
- Visual captures confirmed the tab-gap top border is absent, image fragments do not bleed around the inner rounded corners, the star's black square no longer appears, and the directional bubble gradients preserve readable text and stronger fill over the star.
- GitHub API checks returned Cinerific 101/29, Alla Vostra 393/69, Credit King 82/0, and Portfolio 133/44 for commits/worklogs respectively.
- Confirmed the four post-Part-1 source commits produce a net 223 insertions and 52 deletions across sixteen tracked paths relative to documentation commit 2e60627. Main matches origin/main at d6af41d.
- After the customary project-reader pass, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt is the only tracked pre-PDF documentation delta. Full diff whitespace checking reports captured trailing whitespace inside the generated snapshot's verbatim source dump; there are no uncommitted application-source changes.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/page.tsx - selected beliefs-star4.png, added the seven workflow image descriptors, and rendered one full-width reference strip for each timeline stage.
- app/globals.css - implemented star scale and placement, taller workflow geometry, responsive image strips, tab opacity and spacing, transparent image masks, split top borders, corner safety cutouts, center-directed belief gradients, and corrected star-layer compositing.
- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - updated only Featured Case Studies commit and worklog quantities from verified remote repository data.
- public/images/aboutdev/beliefs-star-forest-border.png, beliefs-star.png, beliefs-star2.png, beliefs-star3.png, and beliefs-star4.png - preserved the Core Beliefs visual iteration assets, with beliefs-star4.png as the active source.
- public/images/aboutdev/workflow-research-strip.jpg, workflow-plan-strip.jpg, workflow-scaffold-strip.jpg, workflow-analyze-strip.jpg, workflow-testing-strip.jpg, workflow-building-strip.jpg, and workflow-release-strip.jpg - added the seven stage-specific workflow references.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh so the documentation companion records source state d6af41d, the new assets, current Git context, and all prior PDF worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_september29_part2.pdf - generated as this new same-day continuation artifact.

Follow-Up Context

- The workflow image strip is intentionally one continuous full-width crop per stage. Future image replacements should preserve the 127.5px height, responsive object-fit behavior, 95 percent tab surfaces, eight-pixel visible tab gap, and ten-pixel hidden corner safety inset.
- Testing, Building, and Release still retain placeholder banner bodies from Part 1. Their image evidence is now present, but future body-copy work should not collapse the seven-stage stagger or alter the new image/tab geometry without explicit review.
- The belief gradients are tied to the current five-circle coordinates and the star's 45 percent center. Moving bubbles or the star should trigger recalculation of the five angles rather than copying the existing values blindly.

- The black-background solution depends on screen blending at the star-layer level and a non-isolated parent. Restoring isolation or moving blending back to the image will reveal the raster rectangle again.
- beliefs-star4.png still contains the original black field. A later genuinely transparent export could replace the compositing workaround, but it should preserve the same artwork, dimensions, color relationships, and accepted placement.
- Featured Case Studies quantities are hardcoded display strings verified against remote repository state at the time of this record. Future refreshes should repeat the GitHub default-branch and remote-tree checks rather than count local clones.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies the message and requests the operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september29_part2.pdf.
- Used the Part 2 suffix because portfolio_worklog_september29.pdf already documents the earlier September 29 session and the mature series adds Part suffixes for distinct same-day continuation records.
- Produced a US Letter, PDF 1.4, unencrypted document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: d6af41d7ca989395c01d52693ef4f2c75fb05112 on main and origin/main.
- No source commit, push, deployment, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.